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PREMIUM NOTES

RPSC — Geography Notes (India + Rajasthan)

RPSC Test Series — StuDy

High-yield facts, formulas and trap-radar — made for the real exam hall.

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RPSC — Geography Notes (India + Rajasthan)

Physical India

- Latitudinal extent 8°4′N–37°6′N; longitudinal 68°7′E–97°25′E. Standard meridian 82°30′E (Mirzapur). Tropic of Cancer divides India almost in half.
- Himalaya: three parallel ranges — Himadri (Greater, avg 6,000 m, Everest 8,848.86 m in Nepal), Himachal (Lesser — hill stations), Shivalik (youngest, foothills). Regional division by rivers: Punjab, Kumaun, Nepal, Assam Himalaya.
- Northern Plains: Bhabar (porous, streams disappear) → Terai (marshy, streams reappear) → Bhangar (old alluvium, kankar) → Khadar (new alluvium, flood plains).
- Peninsular plateau: Deccan triangle; Western Ghats (continuous, higher — Anamudi 2,695 m highest in peninsular India) vs Eastern Ghats (broken, Mahendragiri).
- Coastal plains: Konkan, Malabar (Kerala — backwaters/kayals), Coromandel, Northern Circars. Islands: Andaman–Nicobar (volcanic Barren Island — India's only active volcano), Lakshadweep (coral).

Rivers & Drainage

- Indus system: Indus (origin Tibet, Mansarovar region), Jhelum, Chenab, Ravi, Beas, Sutlej (Bhakra — Gobind Sagar). Indus Waters Treaty 1960.
- Ganga system: Ganga (Bhagirathi + Alaknanda meet at Devprayag), Yamuna (largest tributary), Ghaghara, Gandak, Kosi ('Sorrow of Bihar'), Son (from south). Brahmaputra: Tsangpo in Tibet → Siang/Dihang → Brahmaputra; Majuli = largest river island.
- Peninsular rivers: Godavari (largest peninsular — 'Dakshin Ganga'), Krishna, Kaveri (disputed sharing), Mahanadi (Hirakud), Narmada & Tapi (west-flowing, rift valley, estuaries), Damodar ('Sorrow of Bengal').
- Waterfalls: Jog (Sharavati, Karnataka — among highest), Nohkalikai (Meghalaya — tallest plunge), Chitrakote (Indravati — 'Niagara of India', Chhattisgarh), Dhuandhar (Narmada).

Climate, Soil & Agriculture

- Monsoon: SW monsoon (June–Sept, ~75% rainfall) — Arabian Sea + Bay of Bengal branches; retreating monsoon (Oct–Nov) gives Tamil Nadu its main rain. Western disturbances bring winter rain (mahawat) to the north-west.
- El Niño generally weakens the Indian monsoon; La Niña strengthens it. Mawsynram (Meghalaya) = highest average rainfall.
- Crops: Kharif (sown June — rice, jowar, bajra, maize, cotton, groundnut), Rabi (Nov — wheat, barley, mustard, gram), Zaid (summer — watermelon, fodder).
- Green Revolution: 1960s, HYV + irrigation + fertilisers; M.S. Swaminathan (father in India), Norman Borlaug (world). Punjab–Haryana–western UP belt (wheat first, rice later).
- Major producers (recent pattern): Rice — West Bengal/Telangana top; Wheat — UP; Milk — India world No. 1 (UP top state); Cotton — Gujarat; Sugarcane — UP.

Rajasthan Geography — Rapid Fire

- Physiographic divisions: Western Sandy Plains (Thar), Aravalli Range, Eastern Plains, South-Eastern Plateau (Hadoti).
- Climate zones: Arid (Jaisalmer, Bikaner), Semi-arid (Jodhpur, Nagaur), Sub-humid (Jaipur), Humid (south-east). Hottest: Churu/Ganganagar belt; coldest recordings often Mt Abu / Churu.

- National parks: Ranthambore (Sawai Madhopur), Sariska (Alwar), Keoladeo Ghana (Bharatpur — UNESCO, Siberian crane), Mukundra Hills (Kota), Desert NP (Jaisalmer). Ramsar sites: Keoladeo, Sambhar.
- Minerals: Rajasthan leads in zinc (Zawar, Rampura Agucha), lead, silver, marble (Makrana), gypsum, rock phosphate (Jhamarkotra), lignite (Barmer), crude oil (Barmer — Mangala field).
- Projects: Indira Gandhi Canal (from Harike barrage, Sutlej–Beas — longest canal, 'lifeline of western Rajasthan'), Chambal Project (joint MP–Rajasthan), Mahi Bajaj Sagar (joint Gujarat), Bisalpur (Banas — Jaipur water).

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